Greater Resilience, Innovation & Transformation (GRIT) Lab

Exploring Community Impacts, Energy Transitions, and Conceptual Frontiers for Industrial Decarbonization and Net-Zero Societies

Keynote Speaker

Dr.Benjamin K. Sovacool
Director, Institute of Global Sustainability
Professor Earth & Environment
Boston University

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https://clemson.zoom.us/j/92399744548

Abstract

Decarbonizing Industry: Social, ethical, and political dimensions, industrial decarbonization is often framed as a technical challenge, given the sector's reliance on diverse fuels and complex processes across heterogeneous industries. Solutions typically focus on carbon capture, hydrogen, electrification, and energy efficiency. However, this perspective overlooks critical social and ethical dimensions. Communities and workers dependent on fossil-fuel industries may face economic disruption and livelihood loss. Decisions around complying with climate policies can reshape cultural, economic, and political systems. This presentation emphasizes these nontechnical aspects, highlighting frameworks like Just Transitions and exploring pathways for equitable and accelerated low-carbon transitions.

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Department of Sociology, Anthropology & Criminal Justice, Director of GRIT Lab

Speaker Biography

Dr.Benjamin K. Sovacool

Professor of Earth and Environment, Boston University;
Founding Director, Institute for Global Sustainability;
Professor of Energy Policy, Bennett Institute for Innovation & Policy Acceleration
University of Sussex Business School

Academic Leadership

Fellow of the Royal Society for Arts, Manufactures and Commerce; Fellow of the Academy of Social Sciences; Fellow of Academia Europaea. Previously: Director, Sussex Energy Group (SPRU), University of Sussex; Director, Center for Energy Technologies, Aarhus University; University Distinguished Professor

Research Focus

Energy policy, energy justice, energy security; climate change mitigation and adaptation; renewable energy and energy efficiency; ethics and governance of energy systems; public policy for energy access and resilience. Global work across: Asia, Africa, Europe, North America

Global Recognition

Endorsed by Bill Clinton, Gro Harlem Brundtland, and Elinor Ostrom; Coordinating Lead Author, IPCC Seventh Assessment Report (AR7); Board Member, National Academies of Sciences; Advisor, UK Department for Energy Security and Net Zero

Funding & Impact

Managed over $48 million in research funding; contributed to projects exceeding $259 million. Funding sources include: the U.S. Department of Energy, National Science Foundation, European Commission, European Research Council, Rockefeller Foundation, MacArthur Foundation

Awards

USERN Prize (2019); Dedication to Justice Award (American Bar Association); Distinguished Alumni Award (Virginia Tech); Spirit Award (University of Sussex). Among the top 1% most cited social scientists globally; ranked in the top 1% annually from 2019–2025

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